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HONG KONG'S BLACKHORN COVERS FULL SPECTRUM OF CLIENTS' NEEDS

Tom Burroughes, ***WealthBriefingAsia*** Group Editor, talks to **Yugi Lee** & **Mary Chiu**, Co-Founders, **Blackhorn Wealth Management Ltd**.

Please explain what you think makes your firm successful in its chosen field?

Blackhorn Wealth Management is an independent wealth management organisation based in Hong Kong. Our team draws on decades of experience in private wealth and investing to provide best-in-class wealth solutions for our clients and their families.

What makes us exceptional is the diverse experiences and knowledge of our team members. Our team offers a wealth of expertise across all traditional asset classes as well as alternatives, digital assets, derivatives, and foreign exchange. Clients are experiencing market conditions now that haven't been seen in recent times and we are able to offer a range of solutions to manage risks.

We take a long-term view of investments, considering each client's individual needs in a collaborative way. At the same time, we are actively taking advantage of shifting market trends by using short-term, tactical trades to protect client assets, provide yield enhancement and reduce borrowing costs in a rising-rate environment. For example, we're able to maximise yield enhancement strategies by selling volatility and leveraging FX strategies to lower borrowing costs for clients needing to hold multiple currencies or financing hard assets in foreign jurisdictions.

What have been the main obstacles you had to overcome and how did you do so to reach this level?

Being a smaller and newer player in the field has meant that we've had to work harder to gain visibility. We've been very fortunate in our partnerships with several private banks and financial institutions in the region. Many of these relationships have taken years for our team to cultivate – long before Blackhorn Wealth Management came into existence. Our strength in these relationships has been a boon for our clients looking to take advantage of our partnerships with not just a few names, but our clients have several names to consider and choose from to suit their needs.

Since Blackhorn Wealth Management's inception, we have already attracted close to USD1 billion in AUM. We owe this success to the strong level of trust that our clients have put into our expertise.

Where in the world do you operate – are you mainly a domestic player or an international player?

We are very focused on the regional needs of our clients – mainly Hong Kong and China. We must also be knowledgeable about cross-border taxation legislation on a global level since many of our clients may have assets and businesses in several parts of the world including the United Kingdom, Australia, Canada, and Southeast Asia. When helping clients with estate planning, oftentimes we must consider dual or multiple passport holders when structuring assets for wealth transfer. Blackhorn Wealth Management has partnered with reputable specialists in these areas to help clients navigate their specific needs.

Whom do you look to in terms of ideas and inspiration? What other business sectors do you follow for ideas?

Our clients are our best source of ideas and inspiration. We're often presented with a unique set of issues for each client. Their backgrounds are diverse, ranging from real estate and commodities to technology, and services – spanning across borders. Our team works closely with clients to identify solutions that fit into their overall strategies, and we learn a great deal about operating within their specific industries along the way.

We are always looking for innovative ways to offer wealth management solutions and technology is a space that we follow very closely for ideas. Falling behind on technological trends is not an option in a fast-moving market. Our team reviews trends in this space regularly and discusses a range of topics including digital assets, artificial intelligence, renewables, and biotechnology. We are fascinated by the changing world around us and curiosity is a mindset that keeps us motivated. ■

Yugi Lee & Mary Chiu
Co-Founders
Blackhorn Wealth Management Ltd